

CONQUERING THE SUMMIT

Let us do these activities before we read.

I Identify the activities represented by the icons given below. Share your answers with your classmates and the teacher.

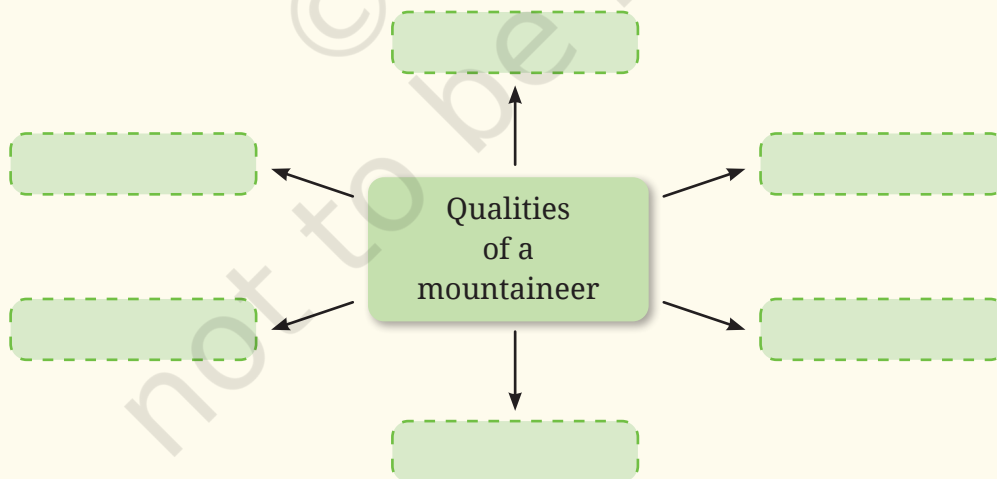


II Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1. Why do you think people undertake the activities identified above?
2. How would they prepare for these activities?
3. Which one of them do you find the most exciting? Why?

Share your answers with the teacher.

III Work in pairs to complete the word web given below. Share the answers with the teacher.





Let us read

This is a story that narrates the triumph of will, courage, determination, and dedication. Arunima Sinha's journey from a devastating accident to scaling the highest peak in the world stands as a **beacon** of hope and **resilience**. In 2011, at the age of 24, Arunima Sinha, a national-level volleyball player, faced a life-altering event. It challenged her in ways she could never have imagined. As she lay in the hospital bed with one leg **amputated**, Arunima made a vow that many would deem impossible: not only to walk again with a **prosthetic leg** but to scale Mount Everest. In 2013, she did just that, becoming the first Indian female amputee to achieve this **feat**. Hence, in 2015, she was awarded the Padma Shri, the fourth highest civilian award in India. She was also awarded the Tenzing Norgay National Adventure Award and National Award for Best Female Mountaineer.

Arunima hails from Ambedkar Nagar, a small district in Uttar Pradesh. Her father was an army engineer, and her mother worked as a health supervisor. Sports were a significant part of Arunima's life, with her family having a natural inclination towards athletics. After completing her law degree following her post-graduation, Arunima decided to pursue a job in the paramilitary forces, which would allow her to continue her passion for sports while having a regular income.

On the fateful night of 11 April 2011, she met with a train accident. The hours that followed were **harrowing**. She never imagined she would survive that night, but survive she did, miraculously, displaying an extraordinary will to live. Arunima received a prosthetic leg and underwent physiotherapy. It was during this period that she made a profound decision. Inspired by an article about Mount Everest, she resolved to conquer the highest peak in the world.

To pursue her ambition, Arunima Sinha completed a basic mountaineering course at the Nehru Institute of Mountaineering in Uttarkashi, followed by eighteen months of **rigorous** training. Arunima approached Bachendri Pal, the



Courtesy: Hindustan Times

beacon:

source of inspiration

resilience:

ability to recover quickly from a difficulty

amputated: cut off a part of the body (here the leg)

prosthetic leg:

an artificial leg that helps people to move around easily

feat:

achievement

harrowing:

extremely disturbing and painful

rigorous:

severe





endeavour: an attempt to do something

surge: a sudden and great increase

endurance: (here) ability to continue doing something difficult for a long time

first Indian woman to summit Everest, to guide her in the **endeavour**. Bachendri Pal instilled confidence in Arunima and said, “My child, you decided to climb Mount Everest in these situations with a prosthetic leg—you have conquered the Everest within you; the world will realise it later.”

On 21 May 2013, after 52 exhausting days, Arunima Sinha reached the summit of Mount Everest. Standing at the top of the world, she felt a **surge** of emotions—pride, relief, and an overwhelming sense of achievement. She displayed the Indian flag at the summit and left behind a photograph of her idol, Swami Vivekananda, whose teachings had inspired her throughout her journey.

Arunima’s feat did not end with Everest. By July 2016, she had summited seven peaks in Europe, Africa, Australia, South America, North America, and of course, Mount Everest in Asia. In January 2019, she climbed the seventh peak on Antarctica and became world’s first female amputee to climb Mount Vinson. Her goal to complete the Seven Summits was achieved.

Throughout her journey, Arunima has faced numerous challenges and setbacks. Yet, her story is not just about physical **endurance** but also about mental





fortitude and the power of a positive mind set. Her message is simple yet profound: “Never give up and work hard. Always remember your goal and work on it.”

Arunima’s autobiography, *Born Again on the Mountain: A Story of Losing Everything and Finding It Back* records her incredible journey to the top of the world. It is a story of triumph over **adversity**, a **testament** to the human spirit’s capacity to rise above the most challenging circumstances.

She was **conferred** with the honorary doctorate by the University of Strathclyde, Glasgow, UK. In her words, “Failure is not when we fall short of achieving our goals. It is when we don’t have goals worthy enough. Never forget your goal, respect it, work hard, and you will be the winner.” Dr. Arunima Sinha has not only conquered mountains but has also won people’s hearts the world over, inspiring them to reach their own summits.

fortitude:
courage over a long period

adversity:
a difficult situation

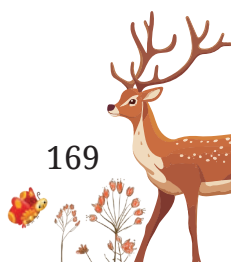
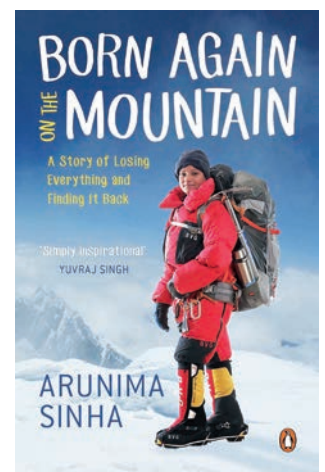
testament:
proof

conferred:
given an official title or honour

Let us discuss

I Read the statements given below and explain each statement in your words.

1. Arunima Sinha is considered a beacon of hope and resilience.
2. Arunima decided to climb Mount Everest despite losing her leg.
3. Bachendri Pal’s guidance was crucial in Arunima’s journey to the summit of Mount Everest.
4. Arunima’s achievements go beyond just physical endurance.
5. Arunima’s autobiography inspires readers around the world.





Let us think and reflect

I Read the extract given below and answer the questions that follow.

Bachendri Pal instilled confidence in Arunima and said, “My child, you decided to climb Mount Everest in these situations with a prosthetic leg—you have conquered the Everest within you; the world will realise it later.”

On 21 May 2013, after 52 exhausting days, Arunima Sinha reached the summit of Mount Everest. Standing at the top of the world, she felt a surge of emotions—pride, relief, and an overwhelming sense of achievement.

1. Complete the sentence with a suitable reason.

Bachendri Pal said that Arunima had conquered the Everest within her because _____.

2. How might Arunima have felt after what Bachendri Pal told her?

3. Choose a phrase from the extract which shows that reaching the summit of Mount Everest was tiring.

4. Select the correct option to complete the sentence.

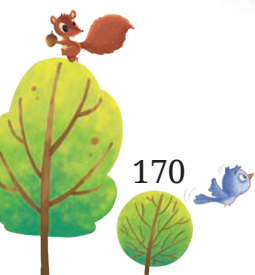
After her success when Arunima felt ‘an overwhelming sense of achievement’, she would have most likely said, “_____.”

- (i) I am confident of my abilities
- (ii) I will accomplish this soon
- (iii) I am excited to begin this climb
- (iv) I finally realised my dream

II Answer the following questions.



1. What did Arunima do in order to fulfill her ambition of conquering Mount Everest?
2. Arunima is a beacon of hope and resilience. Support this statement with evidence from the text.
3. Arunima’s autobiography is titled *Born Again on the Mountain: A Story of Losing Everything and Finding It Back*. Why do you think this title is appropriate?
4. Arunima says, “Failure is when we don’t have goals worthy enough.” What would be the most likely impact of this statement on readers?





Let us learn

I Read the underlined phrases in sentences (i)–(v) and match them with their appropriate meanings given in the box below.

1. genuine, sincere efforts
2. strength of mind
3. periods of time filled with tiring and demanding activities
4. an incident or experience that significantly changes a person's life
5. a source of inspiration or encouragement

- (i) Nisha was relieved when the final match was over after several exhausting days of practice.
- (ii) Despite several failures, her heartfelt attempts to learn the guitar showed her determination and passion for music.
- (iii) Moving to a new city was a life-altering event for Jagan, as it gave him the chance to make new friends and try different activities.
- (iv) Competing in the marathon requires not just physical strength but also mental fortitude to stay focused and finish the race.
- (v) The lighthouse served as a beacon of hope for the sailors lost at sea.

II Complete the following table by filling in the gaps with correct parts of speech mentioned. An example has been done for you.

Nouns	Adjectives	Verbs (present)	Adverbs
determination	determined	determine	determinedly
relief			relievedly
	inspiring	inspire	
resistance			resistantly
success	successful		



III Study the highlighted words in the following sentences from the text.

- Arunima made **a** vow that many would deem impossible.
- Her father was **an** army engineer.
- Standing at **the** top of the world, she felt **a** surge of emotions—pride, relief, and **an** overwhelming sense of achievement.
- She planted **the** Indian flag at **the** summit and left behind **a** photograph of her idol, Swami Vivekananda.
- Arunima Sinha's journey from **a** devastating accident to scaling **the** highest peak in **the** world stands as a beacon of hope and resilience.

The highlighted words are **articles**.

'A' and 'an' are indefinite articles; 'the' is the definite article. The choice between 'a' and 'an' depends on the sound that follows the article, specifically the initial sound of the word that follows.

1. Fill in the blanks with 'a', 'an', 'the'. Put an 'x' where no article is required.

We planned (i) _____ adventurous trip to (ii) _____ remote island. (iii) _____ island was known for its beautiful landscapes and (iv) _____ diverse wildlife. On (v) _____ first day, we set out to explore (vi) _____ island's dense jungle. (vii) _____ guide led us through (viii) _____ thick foliage and showed us (ix) _____ hidden waterfall. In (x) _____ evening, we gathered around (xi) _____ campfire to share stories and enjoy (xii) _____ meal we cooked. (xiii) _____ experience was truly unforgettable, and we felt (xiv) _____ connection with (xv) _____ nature.

2. There is an error in each sentence that has been underlined. Correct the error in the following sentences.

- (i) We waited for a hour before the bus finally arrived.
- (ii) The guide insisted on an uniform jacket for the group's safety during the trek.
- (iii) Mount K2 is a second highest peak in the world.
- (iv) A Ganga is a sacred river in India, known for its cultural importance.
- (v) Challenges are faced with courage and determination by a brave.
- (vi) A North Star has guided travellers for centuries.



Let us listen



You will listen to five speakers share their opinion about adventure sports. As you listen match the statements 1–8 with the speakers (i)–(v). There are three extra statements that you do not need. (Transcript for the teacher on pg. 177)

Statements	Speaker no.
1. Talks about having basic activities in adventure sports	
2. Finds adventure sports thrilling and exciting	
3. Praises the availability of a variety of activities	
4. Expresses concern about the risks in adventure sports	
5. Promotes trekking as a casual sport	
6. Invites applications from first-timers	
7. Focuses on the availability of training and supervision	
8. Finds exposure to risks unnecessary	



Let us speak

In groups of four, select a role from 1–4 given below and speak about the views allotted to each. Use the prompts and vocabulary given. Take turns to express your opinions, agreement, and disagreement.

Role-Specific Prompts

1. School Student: Talk about why you think Physical Education should be included in school activities.
2. Parent: Discuss your concerns or support for your child participating in Physical Education activities.
3. Physical Education Teacher: Share your experiences about Physical Education activities and why you think they are valuable.



4. Sports Camp Organiser: Explain how you ensure safety and why you believe sports are beneficial for participants.

Prompts

- In my opinion...
- From my point of view...
- One reason for this is...
- I disagree with the notion that...
- I support this perspective because...
- I find it hard to agree because...
- I believe that...
- I disagree with...
- I agree with the idea that...

Vocabulary you may use

precautions unique experiences fun safe enjoyable thrilling
builds confidence concern explore overcome fear participate



Let us write

Read the various components of a formal letter from the box given below.

complimentary close	receiver's address	subject	date
introduction	statement of request	expression of interest	
salutation	signature line	sender's address	

1. Now, read the letter given below and write the matching components.

Sender's Address _____ →

Date _____ →

Receiver's Address _____ →

_____ School _____ →

Subject: Request to join Adventure Club _____ →

Madam/Sir, _____ →

I am Sreelakshmi, a student of Grade 7-C. I am interested in adventure activities like trekking, hiking, rope climbing, and exploring sites of natural beauty. } _____ →

I would love to be a part of the Adventure Club of the school and participate in the adventure activities organised. } _____ →

I request you to grant me permission to join the club. _____ →

Yours sincerely, _____ →

Sreelakshmi _____ →

2. Write a letter to the Principal of your school requesting her to organise an excursion to a nearby hill station for Grade 7 students of your school.



Let us explore

I Find out more information about the following adventure sports in our country and complete the table given below.

Name	Area	Preferred Time of the Year	Equipment Required
snow skiing	snow- covered hills		skis, ski suit,
trekking		Spring, Autumn, Winter	pole
camping	grassy areas		tent, torch,
river rafting		all year round	
scuba diving			scuba suit, mask, fins,

II Prepare an information booklet with fact sheets of five Indian mountaineers. Include the following information in the fact sheet.

1. name (and photograph, if available)
2. place of birth
3. profession
4. accomplishments—awards or honours
5. training received
6. sport known for (if any)

